INCIDENT HANDLER'S JOURNAL

Cybersecurity Incident Documentation

Organization: Healthcare Clinic
Role: Incident Handler / Security Analyst
Incident Category: Ransomware / Phishing

Date	October 10, 2026
Entry	1
Description	Documentation of a severe ransomware incident at a small primary care healthcare clinic initiated via spear-phishing emails, which resulted in the encryption of vital electronic health records, widespread operational disruption, and an extortion ransom demand.
Tool(s) Used	Incident Handler's Journal, Network and Endpoint Isolation Procedures, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Antivirus tools used during initial triage.
The 5 W's	**1. Who caused the incident?** An organized, unethical threat actor group known for systematically targeting organizations within the healthcare and transportation sectors. **2. What happened?** Employees received targeted phishing emails with malicious attachments that deployed ransomware upon download, encrypting patient records and displaying a ransom note demanding payment for the decryption key. **3. When did the incident occur?** Tuesday morning at approximately 9:00 AM. **4. Where did the incident occur?** Within the enterprise network and computer workstations of a small U.S. primary care healthcare clinic. **5. Why did the incident occur?** The incident succeeded due to insufficient email filtering and a lack of security awareness that allowed malicious attachments to execute, with the attackers seeking financial extortion.
Additional Notes	Immediate investigation is required to determine whether offline, immutable backups exist to restore clinical operations without paying the ransom. In the remediation phase, robust email gateway security and mandatory employee awareness training on phishing identification should be implemented.